About The Author



William Shakespeare (1564-1616) was a prolific writer during the Elizabethan and Jacobean ages of British theatre (sometimes called the English Renaissance). Shakespeare's plays are perhaps his most enduring legacy, but they are not the only things he wrote. Shakespeare's poems remain popular to this day. Shakespeare's rich and diverse works have spawned countless adaptations across multiple genres and cultures. His writings have been compiled in various iterations of *The Complete Works of William Shakespeare*, which include all his plays, sonnets, and other poems. William Shakespeare continues to be one of the most important literary figures of the English language.

Glossary

time	-	lifetime
parts	-	here, characters
ages	-	here, periods of time
mewling	-	a small weak noise that a cat makes
puking	-	vomiting
whining	-	expressing unhappiness
creeping	-	walking slowly
satchel	-	a shoulder bag
furnace	-	place where fire is made
woeful	-	unhappy
oaths	-	promises
pard	-	a large cat, such as a leopard
justice	-	here, a judge, someone very respected
saws	-	sayings
pouch	-	a small bag for carrying money
hose	-	tights, thin trousers that men wore in Shakespeare's time
a world too wide	-	much too big
pipes	-	a high sound
second childishness	-	being like a child again
Sans	-	without

Contextual meaning of a few difficult phrases.

Line 13:

'*jealous in honour*': The young man takes great care of his honour, his reputation as a good man.

Line 13:

'*sudden and quick in quarrel*': 'quarrel' is a slightly old-fashioned word for an argument; 'sudden' here means unpredictable - so in an argument this young man might suddenly become violent.

12th General_English_Unit_3_B_Poem.indd 90 07-12-2021 18:03:23